DEREK
KOCH

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Economics graduate (B.A., Cum Laude) with a full year of billing, collections, and payment reconciliation experience in a high-volume professional practice. Reviews billing and payment data to catch discrepancies, escalates issues, and prepares supporting documentation to resolve them. Builds Excel tools that cut manual rework, trains new staff on billing procedures, and follows compliance policy closely. Works in Excel, SQL, Power BI, and R; Member of The Institute of Internal Auditors (IIA).

WORK EXPERIENCE

Receptionist / Assistant Biller Sep 2025 – Oct 2026
Alberto and Cho Oral and Maxillofacial Surgery Group, LLC | Vernon & Sparta, NJ

- Supported the full billing and collections cycle for a two-office surgical practice seeing 10–30 patients daily, from coverage verification and claim submission through payment posting and closeout
- Reconciled insurance payments against billed amounts across 5 carriers (Cigna, Aetna, MetLife, BCBS, Delta Dental) and collected overdue patient balances
- Reviewed EOBs to identify denial reasons and billing discrepancies, escalated problem accounts, and initiated corrective action through resubmissions and predeterminations
- Prepared and submitted supporting documentation for claims and predeterminations through NEA FastAttach
- Built an Excel estimating tool using VLOOKUP and IF logic to pull fees from carrier fee schedules and recalculate patient estimates automatically, cutting revision time by 10–15 minutes per estimate
- Calculated expected out-of-network reimbursement using carrier portals to resolve high-balance billing disputes
- Served as primary liaison between the doctors, patients, insurance carriers, and referring practices, managing multiple concurrent cases for scheduling and care coordination
- Trained a new receptionist on billing workflows, insurance verification, and estimating procedures
- Followed HIPAA and practice policies in handling protected health information and financial records

Park Associate II (promoted from Cashier) 2023 – 2025
LEGOLAND New York | Goshen, NY

- Promoted from Cashier to Park Associate Tier 2; cross-trained across attractions, retail, and park operations
- Processed and balanced high-volume cash and card transactions in a seasonal retail environment
- Followed standard operating and safety procedures while delivering guest service in a fast-paced, team-based setting

Additional Experience: Cashier, ShopRite (Feb – Mar 2025, seasonal) | Cashier, Lowe's (2022 – 2023)

SKILLS

- **Finance & Billing Operations:** Billing and collections, payment reconciliation, discrepancy and denial resolution, supporting documentation, fee schedules, account closeout
- **Data & Reporting:** Excel (lookup and logical functions, estimating tools), SQL (SQL Server/SSMS, Azure SQL), Power BI, R Studio, Python; ad-hoc analysis and data visualization
- **Risk & Compliance:** Policy and procedure adherence, HIPAA compliance, issue escalation, IIA membership
- **Tools & Methods:** Microsoft Office Suite (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook), Azure DevOps, Agile/Scrum, NEA FastAttach

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- **Microsoft Office Specialist: Excel Expert** (in progress) | **Excel 2019 Associate** (2025)
- **The Institute of Internal Auditors (IIA)**, Member (2026)
- **Associate in General Insurance (AINS)**, The Institutes (in progress)
- **Power BI for Data Analysts** coursework (in progress) | **SQL Fundamentals**, Pluralsight | **Scrum Fundamentals**

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts, Economics (Business Honors) May 2025
William Paterson University, Honors College | Wayne, NJ

- Cum Laude | GPA: 3.46 | Dean's List (2 semesters) | Honors Scholarship recipient
- Relevant Coursework: Applied Data Analytics (R Studio); Research-Based Industry Analysis (econometric analysis)

RESEARCH & PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Independent Study: 2008 Financial Crisis & Household Housing Recovery 2025
William Paterson University | Presented at NJBDA Research Symposium

- Analyzed Federal Reserve Survey of Consumer Finances data in R Studio using difference-in-differences, linear, and logistic regression to measure post-crisis recovery across income brackets
- Found recovery after 2009 concentrated among households earning $350K+; presented findings and visualizations at the statewide New Jersey Big Data Alliance (NJBDA) Research Symposium

Honors Thesis: Business Plan for a Wealth Management Firm Aug 2024 – May 2025

- Led industry analysis for a 7-person team, researching market size, competitors, and target clients to support the plan's financial projections
- Researched federal securities laws and regulatory frameworks; presented and defended recommendations to faculty and industry professionals

EXTRACURRICULAR & VOLUNTEERING

- **Leukemia & Lymphoma Society, Team in Training:** Raised ~$1,500 with a family fundraising team; completed the Marine Corps Marathon and Liberty City Half Marathon
- **Data Analytics & Student Investment Club:** Member (Sept 2024 – May 2025)